# FLEET TEAM DIGEST

## 737MAX-FTD-32-17007

**Issue Title :** Landing Gear Manual Extension Cable Becoming Slack

| Airplane Model | ATA | Minor Model(s) |
|---|---|---|
| 737MAX | 3235-00 | -7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ |

| Other Model(s) | ECCN |
|---|---|
| 737NG | 9E991 |

| Originated Date | Last Revised Date | Created On |
|---|---|---|
| 05/02/2017 | 05/02/2017 | 04/19/2017 |

| Estimated Completion Date | Next Update Date |
|---|---|
| | |

## Applicability

All 737MAX airplanes.

## Description

Boeing has received several reports of 737NG landing gear manual extension system cable problems:

1) Operators have reported that after use of the landing gear manual extension system, one or more of the "T" handles would not reset into the recess in the flight deck floor.

2) Operators have reported that when one of the "T" handles was pulled, an adjacent "T" handle also tended to move. Most commonly this occurred with the nose gear "T" handle and the right main gear "T" handle.

3) Operators have reported that when testing the manual extension system per MPD requirements, one of the cables under the flight deck floor became tangled or jammed in adjacent parts.

## Background

The cables for the three manual extension "T" handles are coiled around pulleys that share a common axle shaft under the flight deck floor. Investigation of the above events revealed that the center (nose gear) pulley and the right main gear pulley are very close together and if these two pulleys touch, friction between the two pulleys could cause both pulleys to rotate when only one "T" handle is pulled.

If this occurs, the cable for the handle that was not pulled will become slack under the cockpit floor and may occasionally tangle in an adjacent component (see attached photo).

Research revealed that a similar problem was found in the Boeing factory in 2000. It was found that if the nut on the shaft that supports the three pulleys was overtorqued, the spacers between the pulleys could become crushed which could cause the pulleys to touch each other and therefore rotate together. Since the center pulley (nose gear) and right gear pulley are very close together, they are most prone to this problem.

Similarly, if sticky liquids or other contaminants spill onto the flight deck floor, the liquid can migrate and dry in the small gap between the nose and right gear pulleys. This can also cause both pulleys to rotate together.

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## Status

Closed.

## Interim Action

None.

## Final Action

Boeing reduced the nut torque to solve this problem in 2000. The new torquing procedure requires that the torque be between 50 and 180 pound-inches. AMM 32-34-11 was revised to reflect the reduced torque value.

## Operator Action

There should be a visible gap between the pulleys for the right gear and the nose gear. If this gap is less than 0.040 inches (1 mm), this indicates that a spacer is crushed and the assembly should be disassembled and repaired. The photo attached to this article shows an airplane where the spacer was crushed due to an overtightened nut, resulting in virtually zero gap between the nose and right gear pulleys.

Also, operators may wish to periodically check for (and clean off) dried or sticky liquids that may have spilled and drained onto the pulleys. As noted above, this is most important in the gap between the nose gear and right main gear pulleys. A convenient time to check this might be during the periodic functional check of the manual extension system required by the MPD.

## Part Information

The part number of the spacer that is most likely to be damaged if the shaft nut is overtorqued is P/N 69-50502-3. This spacer is located between the pulleys for the nose gear and the right main gear. Per drawing requirements, this spacer is intended to be 0.348 +/- 0.005 inches thick. If this spacer is below 0.343 inches thick, contact between the two pulleys may occur.

## Related Categories

- In Service Occurrences : null

## Attachments:

a) Slack Manual Extension "T" Handles

b) Cable Drum

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